

A Two-Tier Strategy for Public Safety around Banner Lane and Sursum Corda

Condensed brief from an 11-page academic policy memo

A classroom policy exercise comparing ways to address concentrated public-safety challenges through both environmental design and long-term social investment.

QUESTION AND APPROACH

The memo defines a local problem, synthesizes evidence on Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design (CPTED), youth employment, addiction treatment, and community violence intervention, and compares three options: the status quo; CPTED alone; and a combined strategy. It then maps implementation responsibilities, sequencing, and evaluation needs.

CONTRIBUTION

The recommended approach pairs near-term improvements - lighting, sightlines, maintenance, and greening - with youth jobs, treatment access, and violence intervention. The implementation section proposes phased action, interagency coordination, community guidance, and public reporting so that decision-makers can track participation, safety indicators, and unintended displacement effects.

SELECTED TAKEAWAYS

- Physical design can reduce immediate opportunities for harm, but lasting safety requires attention to employment, health, and community capacity.
- Implementation quality matters: ownership, timing, funding, resident voice, and measurement should be specified alongside the policy choice.
- Safety improvements should include safeguards against displacement and transparent evaluation that supports course correction.

SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

- Policy-option analysis, evidence synthesis, memo writing, implementation planning, and stakeholder-aware recommendations
- Translation of research into a phased, measurable decision framework

Portfolio note: This was coursework structured for a D.C. Council audience; it was not commissioned by or submitted to the Council. To request the full paper, contact Caleb at contact@caleb-johnston.com.